IDENTITY TO IMPACT · CONCEPT PACK

Built on the rock

Hearing is not enough. Doing is the foundation.

2 activities · Works without internet · Print any section with your browser's Print option



Live it out

Usually about 90 minutes. Adjust to your group.

Overview

LEARNING GOALS

Identity goal
Young people can name something they already know Jesus says, and plan to do it this week.

STEM goal
Young people can explain what helps buildings stay standing: a firm foundation, a wide base, and strong bracing.

Big idea (2 minutes)
"How we see ourselves shapes how we build and how we live. Today's question: is knowing the right thing enough?"

ACTIVITY CHOICES

- **Shake-proof tower**: best for building challenges with a dramatic test.
- **Sand or rock?**: best for a direct, memorable link to the passage.

Identity: Scripture and reflection

Bible passage: Matthew 7:24–27

What it means
At the end of the Sermon on the Mount, Jesus describes two builders. Both hear his words, but only the wise one does what they say. Doing is the rock.

What it doesn't mean
The storm hits both houses. Faith doesn't mean avoiding hard times, and a fallen model doesn't mean weak faith.

Unlearn
Where do you already know the right thing but not do it? What has made knowing feel like enough?

Rediscover
Both builders heard Jesus' words. The wise one put them into practice. That was the rock.

Live it out
Name one thing you already know Jesus says that you'll put into practice this week. Who could help you keep going?

Reflection format idea: Stand and say. Each young person stands on a flat stone or marked spot and says their commitment in one sentence.

Facilitator note

Point out that both houses faced the storm. This guards against the idea that faithful people won't struggle, which can wound young people who are going through hard times.

Activities

Shake-proof tower

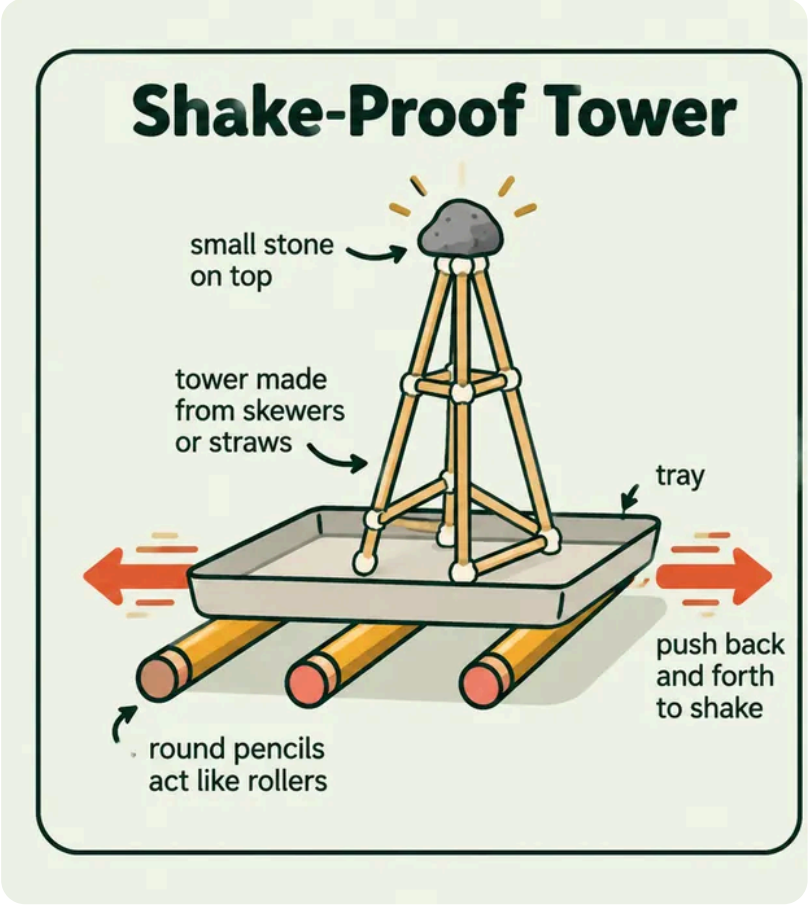
Best for: building challenges with a dramatic test.

About 45 min of activity · prep about 15 min · low cost · indoor

No reading needed | High energy | Low cost | Indoor

Science | **Engineering**

Why this activity: Teams learn that how a tower is built, not how it looks, decides whether it stays standing.



The shake table test, with the tower taped to the tray.

STEM: **Science:** how shaking affects structures; **Engineering:** bracing and bases that resist shaking.

Prep (estimate): About 15 minutes. Set up the shake table and try it yourself.

Materials per team

Wooden skewers or thin sticks, paper, string, modelling clay or tape, and a small stone. Shared: a shake table, which is a flat tray or board resting on 4–6 round pencils or dowels.

Can't find it? *What matters:* thin, straight building pieces and joints that can be strengthened. Straws, dry spaghetti, or thin sticks can replace skewers, but they behave differently, so keep materials the same within a test. Tape can replace clay. For the shake table, any tray or flat board on round pencils or marker pens works. These swaps are our suggestions and haven't been tested, so try one first.

Steps

1. Explain: engineers test buildings on shake tables to see if they survive shaking.
2. Adult preparation: make the shake table. Lay 4 to 6 round pencils side by side on a table and rest the tray on top, so it can slide back and forth.
3. Teams build a tower at least 30 cm tall from skewers, joining them with small balls of clay or tape. It must hold a small stone on top. Predict which part will fail first.
4. Tape the bottom of the tower firmly to the tray.
5. One person shakes for every test: push the tray about 2 cm back and forth for 10 seconds, then about 5 cm for 10 seconds.
6. Find the weak point, strengthen it, and test again with exactly the same shaking.

> **If it doesn't work:** If the tower leans before shaking starts, add triangles (diagonal braces) at the bottom. If joints slip, use more clay or wrap them with tape.

Ask while they work: Which part moved most? Where would a diagonal brace help? Did the stone change how it shook?

Safety: Cover skewer tips. Keep the rollers inside the tray so they don't roll underfoot.

Science, inclusion, and extensions

> **Bridge to reflection:** Every tower looked fine before the shaking. The test showed how each one was built.

The science: A wide base, heavy parts kept low, triangle bracing, and firm joints to the base help structures survive shaking.

> **Make it harder (optional):** Give each team a budget, with a "price" for each material. The tower must reach a minimum height, survive the shaking, and cost as little as possible.

Include everyone: Put the shake table at a height everyone can reach. Blind young people can feel joints and feel the tower shake. Use a finger countdown before each test.

Source: adapted from TeachEngineering, "Shake It Up! Engineering for Seismic Waves," and the Museum of Science, Boston, shake table guidance. Prep times, swaps, calculator amounts, and any changes to the steps are our own and haven't been tested yet.

Have a phone? Try this: Film the shaking in slow motion to see which joint fails first.

Sand or rock?

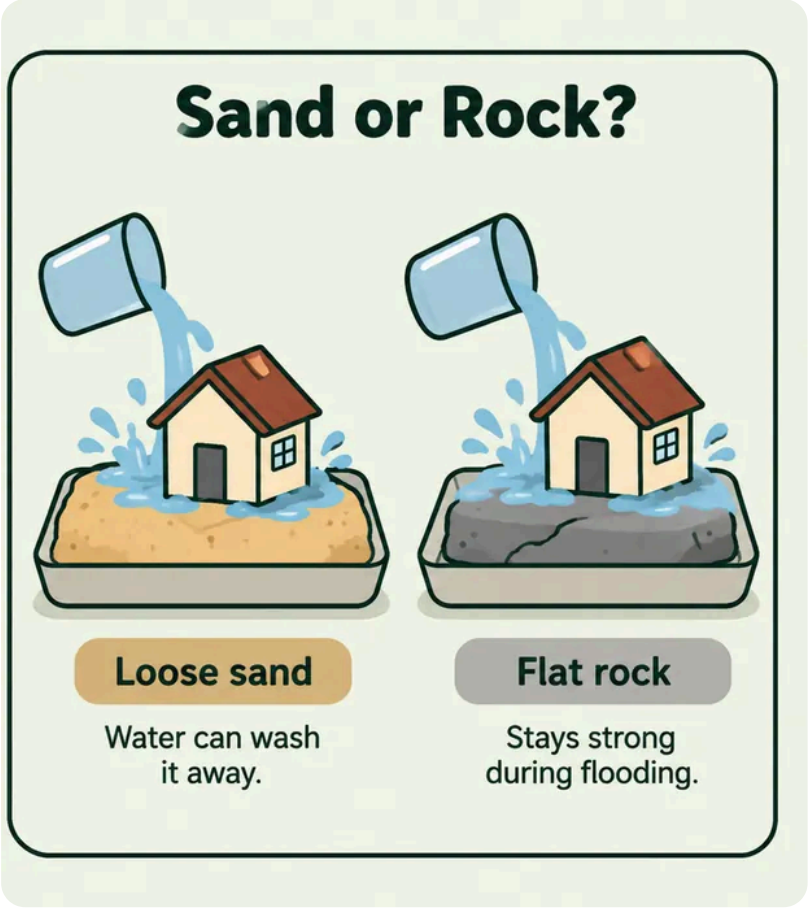
Best for: a direct, memorable link to the passage.

About 30 min of activity · prep about 15 min · free · indoor or outdoor

No reading needed | Medium energy | Free | Indoor or outdoor

Science | **Engineering**

Why this activity: Young people build the same house on two foundations and send the same flood at both, just as in the parable.



Before the flood.

STEM: Science: how water erodes sand; **Engineering:** designing a foundation that stays put.

Prep (estimate): About 15 minutes. Fill trays with sand and find flat stones.

Materials per team

A tray or shallow basin, dry sand, a flat stone, small blocks or matchboxes for model houses, and a jug of water.

Can't find it? *What matters:* loose sand that water can wash away, and a hard, flat surface that it can't. Matchboxes or bottle caps can replace blocks. A tile or brick can replace a flat stone. Any shallow basin works as a tray. These swaps are our suggestions and haven't been tested, so try one first.

Steps

1. In the tray, make a mound of dry sand on one side and place the flat stone on the other.
2. Build two identical model houses from blocks or matchboxes: one on the sand, one on the stone. Predict what the flood will do.
3. Pour one full jug of water slowly between the two houses, from the same height, to make a flood. Observe.
4. Challenge: design a foundation that keeps a house standing even on sand, such as stakes pushed deep or a wider base.
5. Test the new foundation with the same amount of water, poured the same way.

Ask while they work: What happened to the sand under the house? What would a builder do differently? Is our flood the same for both houses?

Safety: Wash hands after handling wet sand. Mop up spills to prevent slipping.

Science, inclusion, and extensions

> **Bridge to reflection:** Same house, same flood. The only difference was what it stood on.

The science: Water washes loose sand from under a structure. Engineers build on soft ground by reaching down to firm layers.

> **Make it harder (optional):** Use only 5 sticks and a handful of stones to make a foundation that keeps the house standing on sand. Compare how far each design tilts.

Include everyone: Young people can feel the difference between the two foundations before and after the flood.

Source: adapted from TeachEngineering, “Erosion in Rivers,” where model buildings are tested on sand. Prep times, swaps, calculator amounts, and any changes to the steps are our own and haven’t been tested yet.

Session plan

A worked plan for about 90 minutes, using **Shake-proof tower**. Times are estimates. Adapt them to your group.

Purpose

- **STEM learning:** how structures resist forces, and strengthening weak points.
- **Identity focus:** building our lives on a firm foundation.

Scripture: Matthew 7:24–27

Jesus ends his Sermon on the Mount with this story. Both builders hear his words; the difference is that one puts them into practice. The storm comes to both houses.

Before the session

- Make the shake table and test it.
- Gather skewers, clay or tape, and small stones.
- Practise one gentle and one stronger shake so you can show them.

Time: preparation about 15 minutes (before participants arrive); session about 90 minutes.

The session

1 Connect

about 10 min

You: Welcome and play "Human knot."

Participants: Take part.

Move on with: "Builders plan for storms. Today we'll test that."

2 Introduce

about 10 min

You: Explain shake tables and show the test: same person, same shaking each time.

Participants: Predict which part will fail first.

Move on with: "Build at least 30 cm tall, with a stone on top."

3 Explore

about 40 min

You: Ask: "Which part moved most? Where would a brace help?"

Participants: Build and do the first shake test.

Move on with: "Find your weak point."

4 Improve and share

about 15 min

You: Ask teams to strengthen one weak point and test again with the same shaking.

Participants: Share what made the biggest difference.

Move on with: "Both towers faced the same shaking."

5 Reflect

about 15 min

You: Read Matthew 7:24–27. Use the questions below.

Participants: Talk in pairs, then share.

6 Live it out and close

about 5–10 min

You: Invite one action. Ask for feedback. Tidy up.

Participants: Name one action.

Reflect: questions from the experience

- What kept your tower standing?
- Unlearn: what have you been building your life on that might not hold?
- Rediscover: what does Jesus say makes a strong foundation?

Live it out (optional action)

This week, put one thing you have heard from Jesus into practice.

Close, feedback, and cleanup

Ask what they would build differently. Collect skewers safely (points down) and return materials.

Using the other activities in this theme

- **Sand or rock?:** About 30 minutes. Messier, so work outside or over a tray. It uses the passage's own picture, so let participants make the connection themselves rather than telling them.

Running the session

Before each session

- Try the activity yourself. Cut or prepare anything that slows building.
- Put materials into one set per team.
- Read the Bible passage and notes, and answer the three questions yourself first.
- Check who your safeguarding lead is.
- Make sure consent and health forms are in for every young person.

The session flow

Every session follows the same six steps. The times are estimates for a 90-minute session. Your group sets the pace, so adjust as you go.

1 Connect — about 10 min

Welcome everyone. Play a warm-up game. In the first session, agree group agreements. In later sessions, ask how last week's Live it out step went.

2 Introduce — about 10 min

Share a real-world problem and the big idea. Show the key steps and the safety rules. Teams predict what will happen.

3 Explore — 25–45 min, depending on the activity

Teams build or investigate. Walk around and ask questions while they work.

4 Improve and share — 10–20 min

Teams change one thing, test again, and tell the group what they found.

5 Reflect — about 15 min (at least 10)

Use the Bible passage and the three reflection questions. Talk in pairs first, then as a group. Connect reflection to what actually happened.

6 Live it out and close — 5–10 min

Each person names one small action for the week. Ask for quick feedback. Clean up together and close.

How the flow supports the learning journey

I2I's learning journey is **Unlearn** → **Rediscover** → **Live it out** → **Impact**. The session flow is how you walk that journey in one meeting. Connect and Introduce raise the questions. Explore and Improve give a shared experience to think about. Reflect moves through Unlearn and Rediscover. Live it out and close turns reflection into one action, and repeated actions lead to Impact over time.

When things don't go to plan

- **People arrive late:** start Connect with whoever is there. Give late arrivals a role in an existing team rather than repeating instructions for everyone.
- **Instructions aren't clear:** stop the group, demonstrate the step again with real materials, and ask one participant to explain it back.
- **Materials are limited:** use bigger teams, give each person a clear role, or prepare some parts beforehand.
- **A build fails, or results differ from predictions:** treat it as data. Ask, "What happened? Why? What will you change?" Don't fix it for them.
- **A team finishes early:** offer the activity's "Make it harder" idea, or ask them to help test another team's design.
- **Building or discussion takes longer:** shorten Improve and share to one quick change and one retest. Keep at least 10 minutes for Reflect and 5 for closing.
- **A project needs more time:** pause at a clear point, store the work safely, and continue next session, starting with a short reminder of what each team was doing.

Always protect: safety, every participant having a real role, a short reflection, and the closing. Everything else can be shortened.

Friendly competition (optional)

Some activities, such as the catapult target round or the balloon car distance test, can include a friendly challenge. Use clear criteria, the same materials and practice time for every team, and keep everyone taking part. No one is eliminated. Recognise improvement, careful testing, and teamwork as well as results. Never score faith, personal sharing, or spiritual growth. The community showcase is never a competition.

The session steps are adapted from the UNICEF Adolescent Kit guide "Eight session steps," which recommends a routine set of steps adapted to each group. UNICEF does not endorse this toolkit.

Starting well

Young people answer honestly only when they feel safe. Build trust before asking personal questions. Start with a game that needs everyone; the Warm-ups page has ideas.

Group agreements

Agree on these in the first session, in the young person's own words if possible. Remind the group each time.

- **You can always pass.** No one has to answer.
- **What others share stays here.** Don't repeat someone's story outside the group.
- **Listen without laughing or fixing.**
- **Speak for yourself.** Share your own story, not someone else's.

Be honest about one limit. Say it at the start: "If someone tells us they are being hurt or are unsafe, we will tell someone who can help." Then no one is surprised later.

Team roles

Give each person a role, and switch roles each session so everyone gets to lead.

Role	What they do
Director	Leads the design and guides builders with words or gestures. A strong role for a young person who can't easily handle materials.
Builder	Handles materials and puts the design together (everyone helps).
Tester	Runs each test fairly and counts or measures the result.
Recorder	Remembers, draws, or writes down predictions and results.
Presenter	Shares the team's design and learning.

Talking about failure

How you respond when a design breaks teaches more than any lesson.

Instead of	Try
"That didn't work."	"What did that test teach you?"
"Here, do it like this."	"Where did it break first? Why there?"

"Good job, you won."	"What change made the biggest difference?"

Leading reflection

Every session ends with the same three questions, in this order.

> **Unlearn**
> What did you believe about yourself while you built? Where did that thought come from?

> **Rediscover**
> What does God say is true about you?

> **Live it out**
> What will you do differently this week? Name one choice, relationship, or habit.

The last answer matters most. "I am wonderfully made" is a good start. "This week I'll share my idea in class instead of staying quiet" is the goal.

Each concept suggests a different way for young people to answer, such as drawing or a pair walk, so reflection stays fresh.

Following up

- **Tell a partner.** Each young person tells a partner their Live it out plan.
- **Check in next time.** If the group meets again, start with: "How did your Live it out go?"
- **Hand it to the church.** After a single session, ask young people if the youth leader can hear their plan. The leader follows up within a week.
- **Grace, not shame.** If someone didn't do it, that's not failure. Ask what got in the way, then try again, the way a team redesigns after a test.

Include everyone in the room

Need	What helps
Limited movement or hand use	A space everyone can reach. Work at a comfortable height. Bigger materials. Offer the Director role.

Need	What helps
Low vision or blind	Let them hold materials and a finished example first. Use tests they can hear or feel. Describe results out loud.
Deaf or hard of hearing	Get their attention, then face them. Don't stand with bright light behind you. Show, then tell. Agree on hand signals. Repeat what others say. Learn a few key signs in your national sign language.
Learning differences	One step at a time. Draw the six steps and point to where you are. Short build rounds. The same routine each time.
Reading difficulties, worry, or shyness	Never make anyone read aloud. Let them draw instead of write. Offer roles that don't need presenting. Tell them before it's their turn.

If a young person tells you about abuse or harm

1. Stay calm. Listen carefully. Don't show shock or doubt.
2. Let them speak at their own pace, in their own words. Don't ask leading questions or investigate.
3. Tell them they were right to tell you, and that it is not their fault.
4. Don't promise to keep it secret. Explain kindly that you need to tell someone who can help keep them safe.
5. Write down what they said, in their words, with the date and time.
6. Tell your church's safeguarding lead the same day, and follow your church's policy. Don't confront the person they named.

Safety basics

- Adults use knives and cut bottles or thick cardboard. Young people share scissors carefully.
- Check the space for hazards before young people arrive.
- Ask young people and families privately about health needs, such as seizures, allergies, or medicine. Keep this private.
- Have clean drinking water and a basic first-aid kit nearby.

Warm-ups

Short games to build trust at the start, wake people up in the middle, or calm the group after a serious talk. Use them whenever the group needs to connect.

Human Knot

10 min, high energy, start of a session

Stand in a circle. Everyone reaches across and takes two different people's hands, then the group untangles itself without letting go.

Include everyone: If anyone can't take part physically, play Group Story instead.

Name and motion

5 min, medium energy, first session

Each person says their name with a motion. The whole group repeats both. Go around the circle.

Include everyone: A motion can be anything: a nod, a blink, a wave.

Stand up if...

5 min, low to medium energy, start of a session

Read statements such as "Stand up if you've ever fixed something that was broken" or "... if you speak more than one language." Young people discover what they share.

Include everyone: Raising a hand works as well as standing.

Human machine

5 min, medium energy, before a build

One person starts a repeating motion and sound. Others join one at a time, each connecting to someone already moving, until the group becomes one machine.

Why it helps: Every part matters to the whole machine.

Count to 20

5 min, low energy, calming

The group counts aloud, one person at a time, in no set order. If two people speak at once, start again from 1.

Include everyone: For deaf young people, play by raising fingers instead of speaking.

Back-to-back drawing

10 min, low energy, middle of a session

Pairs sit back to back. One describes a simple shape without naming it; the other draws it. Compare, then swap.

Why it helps: Clear communication is a skill engineers depend on.

Three-minute tower

5 min, high energy, before a build

Same and different

5 min, low energy, first session

Teams get 10 sheets of paper and no tape. Build the tallest standing tower in three minutes.

Why it helps: A fast first try, and a reminder that first tries are meant to be improved.

Pairs find three things they have in common and one way they're different.

Mirror

5 min, low energy, after a heavy reflection

Pairs face each other. One moves slowly; the other mirrors. Swap leaders when the facilitator says so.

Strength web

10 min, low energy, closing

Stand in a circle. Holding the end of a ball of string, name a strength you saw in someone, then pass the ball to them. Keep going until everyone is part of the web.

Why it helps: Each person is seen and connected.

Group story

5 min, low energy, any time

The group tells one story, each person adding a single sentence. Everyone can take part from where they sit.

Forms and reflection resources

Consent and health forms are required for every young person. Each form has its own Print button.

Reflection resources for your program Optional

Young people don't need a worksheet every session. Choose a rhythm that fits your group; talking or drawing is welcome too.

One-day workshop

- **Closing conversation:** Ask one or two reflection questions aloud; a written sheet is not expected.

Weekend program

- **First session:** Invite participants to notice strengths, challenges, and how they approach learning. Form: Identity Check.
- **Later session:** Choose one small way to put a lesson into practice. Form: Live It Out.
- **Final session:** Look back on learning and growth together. Form: Final Reflection.

Week-long program

- **Beginning:** Use an Identity Check as a starting point; writing is optional. Form: Identity Check.
- **Middle:** Pick a practical Live It Out action and discuss progress later. Form: Live It Out.
- **Final day:** Close with a brief written, drawn, or spoken reflection. Form: Final Reflection.

Longer series (such as six sessions)

- **Early sessions:** Invite an initial Identity Check. Form: Identity Check.
- **Midway:** Revisit learning with a Live It Out action. Form: Live It Out.
- **Last session:** Use Final Reflection to look back and choose a next step. Form: Final Reflection.

These are suggested moments, not assignments or a measure of spiritual growth. Use only the forms that help your participants.

Looking for a starting activity? Explore warm-up ideas. Need the full forms? Browse all forms.

Participation and consent template

Check your requirements

Purpose	Records agreement to take part and photo choices.
Who uses it	Families, or older participants themselves.
When	Before the first session.
Is it needed?	Follow your church's policy and local law. If your church already has a consent form, use it instead.
Who keeps it	The organiser, stored securely.
Printing	Yes, one per participant, unless you use an existing form.

Identity to Impact is a hands-on STEM programme run by _____ (church or organisation). Participants build, test, and improve designs in teams, and reflect on what the Bible says about who they are. At least two trusted adults supervise every session.

Participant's name _____ Age _____

Parent or guardian (if under 18) _____ Phone _____

☐ I agree to take part (or for the participant to take part) in Identity to Impact sessions.

☐ Photos or videos may be taken for programme use.
☐ These photos or videos may be shared publicly (for example, on church social media).
☐ No photos or videos, please.

Signature _____ Date _____

Signed by a parent or guardian for participants under 18 (or under the age your local rules set). Participants aged 18–19 can sign for themselves.

Health and emergency information

Check your requirements

Purpose	Gives adults the health and emergency details they may need.
Who uses it	Families, or older participants themselves.
When	Before the first session.
Is it needed?	Strongly recommended. Use your church's existing record if it has one.
Who keeps it	The lead facilitator, kept private and shared only with adults who need it.
Printing	Yes, unless you use an existing record.

Young person's name _____

Emergency contact _____ Phone _____

Second contact _____ Phone _____

Allergies (including latex or food) _____

Medical conditions (e.g. seizures, asthma) _____

Medication and what to do in an emergency _____

Anything that helps this young person take part fully _____

Parent or guardian signature _____ Date _____

Attendance sheet

Recommended

Purpose Shows who came and who had the chance to take part.
Who uses it The facilitator.
When Every session.
Is it needed? Recommended. Your church may already keep attendance; use that if so.
Who keeps it The organiser.
Printing Optional. A notebook works.

Church or site _____ Facilitator _____

#	Name	Age	Consent	Health form	Date:	Date:	Date:	Date:	Date:
1									
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#	Name	Age	Consent	Health form	Date:	Date:	Date:	Date:	Date:
17									
18									
19									
20									

Our group agreements Optional

Purpose	Reminds everyone of the agreements the group made.
Who uses it	The whole group.
When	The first session, then displayed each time.
Is it needed?	Optional.
Who keeps it	The group.
Printing	Optional; it can be written on a board.

1. You can always pass.
2. What others share stays here.
3. Listen without laughing or fixing.
4. Speak for yourself.

If someone tells us they are being hurt or are unsafe, the adults will tell someone who can help.

Session reflection Optional

Purpose	Lets participants say what they did and noticed, without scores.
Who uses it	Participants.
When	At the end of a session, if helpful.
Is it needed?	Optional. Participants can skip any question or the whole sheet.
Who keeps it	Participants keep it, or the facilitator collects it only if participants agree.
Printing	Optional.

No name needed. Skip any question. You can write, draw, or tell a facilitator privately.

Date _____ Activity _____

Today...	Yes	A bit	Not yet	No chance today
I tried an idea and tested it.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I used what happened in a test to change something.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I shared an idea or helped someone in my team.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I felt included in my team.	☐	☐	☐	☐

Asking for help or getting help is a good thing. It does not mean you did less well.

One thing I learned or noticed today (words or a drawing):

Anything you want the facilitator to know (optional):

Identity check Optional

Purpose	Lets participants notice how their own views change across a series.
Who uses it	Participants.
When	Only at the start and end of a series, not every session.
Is it needed?	Optional, and only for a series.
Who keeps it	If collected, the organiser stores it securely. Use a participant code, not a name, and agree who can see it.
Printing	Optional.

There are no right or preferred answers. Your answers show how you see things now. They are not a score of faith and do not prove change.

Participant code (only if your organisation matches start and end answers) _____

☐ Start of series ☐ End of series

Statement	Not true	A little	Mostly	Very true	Not sure
I can name a voice that has shaped how I see myself.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I can say something God says about who I am.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have done something differently because of what I believe.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I believe my small actions can make a difference.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Live it out follow-up notes Optional

Purpose	Helps you remember what participants chose to share, so you can ask kindly next time.
Who uses it	The facilitator.
When	At the next session.
Is it needed?	Optional.
Who keeps it	The facilitator, kept private.
Printing	Optional; a notebook works.

For the facilitator's memory only. Write an action down only if the participant agrees. Private actions do not go here. Not trying, forgetting, or finding it hard are all fine.

First name or code (with permission)	Action they chose to share	What they shared later (if anything)	Difficulties	Possible next step

Final reflection Optional

Purpose	Collects examples, questions, and feedback about the programme.
Who uses it	Participants.
When	At the end of a series.
Is it needed?	Optional.
Who keeps it	The organiser, if participants hand it in.
Printing	Optional; it can be a group discussion.

No name needed. Answer any questions you like, in writing, by drawing, in pairs, or to a facilitator.

1. Which session or activity was most useful or enjoyable, and why?

2. Was there a time something from a session came up in your life? (optional)

3. What questions do you still have?

4. Did you feel included? What would have helped?

5. What should we keep, and what should we change?

Incident or accident report

Follow your procedures

Purpose	Records an injury, accident, or near miss.
Who uses it	The facilitator.
When	The same day as any incident.
Is it needed?	Use your church's procedure; this template supports it.
Who keeps it	The programme lead or safeguarding lead.
Printing	Yes, if your church has no form of its own.

Date and time _____ Location _____

Person involved _____ Reported by _____

What happened?

_____

_____

Injuries and first aid given

_____

Parent or guardian informed? ☐ Yes ☐ No. By whom and when:

_____

What will we change to prevent this happening again?

_____

Disclosure record

Follow your procedures

Purpose Records exactly what a young person said if they share that they are being harmed.

Who uses it The adult they told.

When As soon as possible after a disclosure.

Is it needed? Always follow your church's safeguarding policy. Use this only if it has no form of its own.

Who keeps it The safeguarding lead only.

Printing Yes, if needed.

Date and time of disclosure _____ Place _____

Young person's name _____ Age _____

Adult who received the disclosure _____

What the young person said, in their own words:

_____

_____

_____

How they appeared, and anything you observed:

_____

What you said or did in response:

_____

Passed to safeguarding lead (name, date, time) _____

Signature _____